

BST $\leftrightarrow$ Tegmark's Mathematical Universe
Hypothesis: where we agree, where we
genuinely diverge — an honest, non-co-optable
one-pager. BST is a CONCRETE, FORCED,
FALSIFIABLE instance of 'physics is a
mathematical structure', not the Level-IV 'all
structures exist' thesis. GATED: shelf-only
until the internal-SM theorem clears the gate +
Cal-vet + both voices + Casey GO.

Lyra (with Keeper — build, not audit)

2026-08-21

BST and the Mathematical Universe — one forced structure, not all of them

(Honest one-pager. Tegmark's Mathematical Universe Hypothesis (MUH) is a philosophical thesis that physical reality is a mathematical structure. BST is a concrete, falsifiable instance of that vision — one specific forced object — and it deliberately does not adopt the part of MUH that makes it unfalsifiable. The value of contact is that BST is what MUH would look like if it had teeth.)

The shared conviction

Both hold that the constants and laws of physics are not free inputs — they are properties of a mathematical structure. Tegmark argues this in general (reality is isomorphic to some mathematical structure; the “unreasonable effectiveness of mathematics” is because physics is math). BST exhibits it in the concrete: a single forced bounded symmetric domain, $D_{IV}^5 = SO_0(5,2)/[SO(5) \times SO(2)]$, from which the discrete internal Standard-Model skeleton is a function of one measured integer, $n_C = 5$ (gauge dimensions, chirality, the Majorana neutrino, three generations,

anomaly-freedom — all readings of the same integer).

The three-layer ontology (the structural content, up top)

BST’s “the universe is this object” is not a slogan — it is a layered geometric statement. One object, three layers, three tiers of how far we have gotten:

layer	where in D_IV ⁵	what it is	BST tier today
discrete	the Shilov boundary $\partial_S = (S^4 \times S^1)/\mathbb{Z}_2$	the internal SM skeleton — the reality-type census $(\mathbb{C}, \mathbb{H}, \mathbb{R})$, chirality, generations	Derived (the internal-SM theorem — the lead, shippable result)
curvature	the bulk interior (Bergman metric)	the curved bulk — gravity / the dynamical sector	Framework (the geometry–physics seam; hosted, not yet forced)
continuous	the emergent 4D physics read off the structure	continuous spacetime + fields as we measure them	open (the “home” frontier — approached after the internal SM ships)

The honest headline of the table: exactly one of the three layers is a theorem today (the discrete boundary), one is a framework (the curved bulk), and one is open. We say which is which — that is the non-co-optable part.

The one honest divergence, stated plainly

BST does not claim the Level-IV multiverse. Tegmark’s MUH says *all* mathematical structures exist physically (the Level-IV ensemble); it is, by design, not falsifiable — any structure is “somewhere.” BST claims the opposite economy: exactly one structure is *forced*, and it is falsifiable. - BST does not need “all math is real.” It needs one object, and it forces that object (Strong-Uniqueness: D_IV⁵ is the smallest bounded symmetric domain that does physics — the internal SM skeleton is a function of the single integer $n_C=5$, tiebroken by the measured $N_c=3$). - So BST is not a survey of possible universes; it is a derivation of this one. Where MUH explains fine-tuning by ensemble (“we observe the structure that permits observers”), BST removes the tuning: there is no dimensionless free parameter to tune — the constants are readings of one integer.

The teeth MUH-in-general does not have (why this is non-co-optable)

A thesis that “reality is some mathematical structure” predicts nothing you could check. BST, being one specific structure, predicts a forbidden list — the Five-Absence set (banked): no GUT, no proton decay, no magnetic monopole, no dark-matter particle, no sterile neutrino, no low-scale SUSY. Each is a consequence of D_{IV}^5 ’s irreducibility, and any single positive detection refutes BST. That is the difference between a philosophy and a physical theory: BST can be *killed*, and it says exactly how. (The internal-SM theorem also *refuses* its own best-looking coincidence — the charged-lepton Koide relation, exact to 0.001% — because its declared calculus cannot read a mass ratio. An instrument that turns away its prettiest match is not an advocacy tool.)

What each has that the other lacks

	Tegmark MUH	BST
the claim	<i>all</i> mathematical structures are physically real (Level IV)	<i>one</i> structure (D_{IV}^5) is forced; physics is read off it
falsifiable	no (by design — the ensemble absorbs any observation)	yes — the Five-Absence forbidden list; one detection kills it
free parameters	not addressed	zero dimensionless — constants are readings of $n_C=5$
scope achieved	philosophical thesis	the discrete internal SM is a theorem; bulk/gravity is framework; spacetime is open

The honest headline for contact

“You argued that physics is a mathematical structure. We think you are right — and we did the narrow, checkable version: not ‘all structures exist,’ but ‘this one is forced.’ Here is the single object, here is the Standard Model’s discrete skeleton as a function of one integer, and here is a forbidden list that will kill the whole thing if any item shows up. That is the version of your hypothesis that a referee can falsify.”

Scope / “home as last” (Casey)

The internal-SM theorem (three invariants of D_{IV}^5 / one integer n_C) is the lead, shippable artifact. The curved bulk (gravity) is framework, and the continuous emergent spacetime — the “home” — is the last frontier. This note is the honest

MUH-positioning map, not a claim that BST completes Tegmark's program. The physics is on GitHub — it is not a manifesto, it is a computation anyone can run.

— Lyra (with Keeper), Tegmark one-pager v0.1, 2026-08-21. SHELF, gated. Built on the banked internal-SM theorem + the Five-Absence set; no overclaim, no numerology. The divergence — one forced structure, not all of them, with a forbidden list — is the honesty that makes contact credible. Nothing pushed.